

# 1981 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1981, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner

**Karl-Heinz Rummenigge**

National team

**West Germany**

Ceremony date

**29 December 1981**

← Previous edition (PDF)

**1980**

Next edition (PDF) →

**1982**

**All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →**

## References & review

**Status: verified**

Last reviewed: 3 September 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>)
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>)
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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.